



the format. Though Punjab crashed out in the quarterfinal, its left-arm seamer Arshdeep Singh used the tournament as a launchpad to earn a spot in Champions Trophy squad after emerging as the top wicket-taker, with 20 scalps in just seven games.

The tournament also served as preparation and a fitness test for India's recovering pace ace Mohammed Shami. The 34-year-old turned out for Bengal in its last three matches, bowling 26 overs and picking five wickets at less than five runs an over to find a place in the Indian team for the white-ball series against England and Champions Trophy. Current Ranji Trophy and Syed Mushtaq Ali

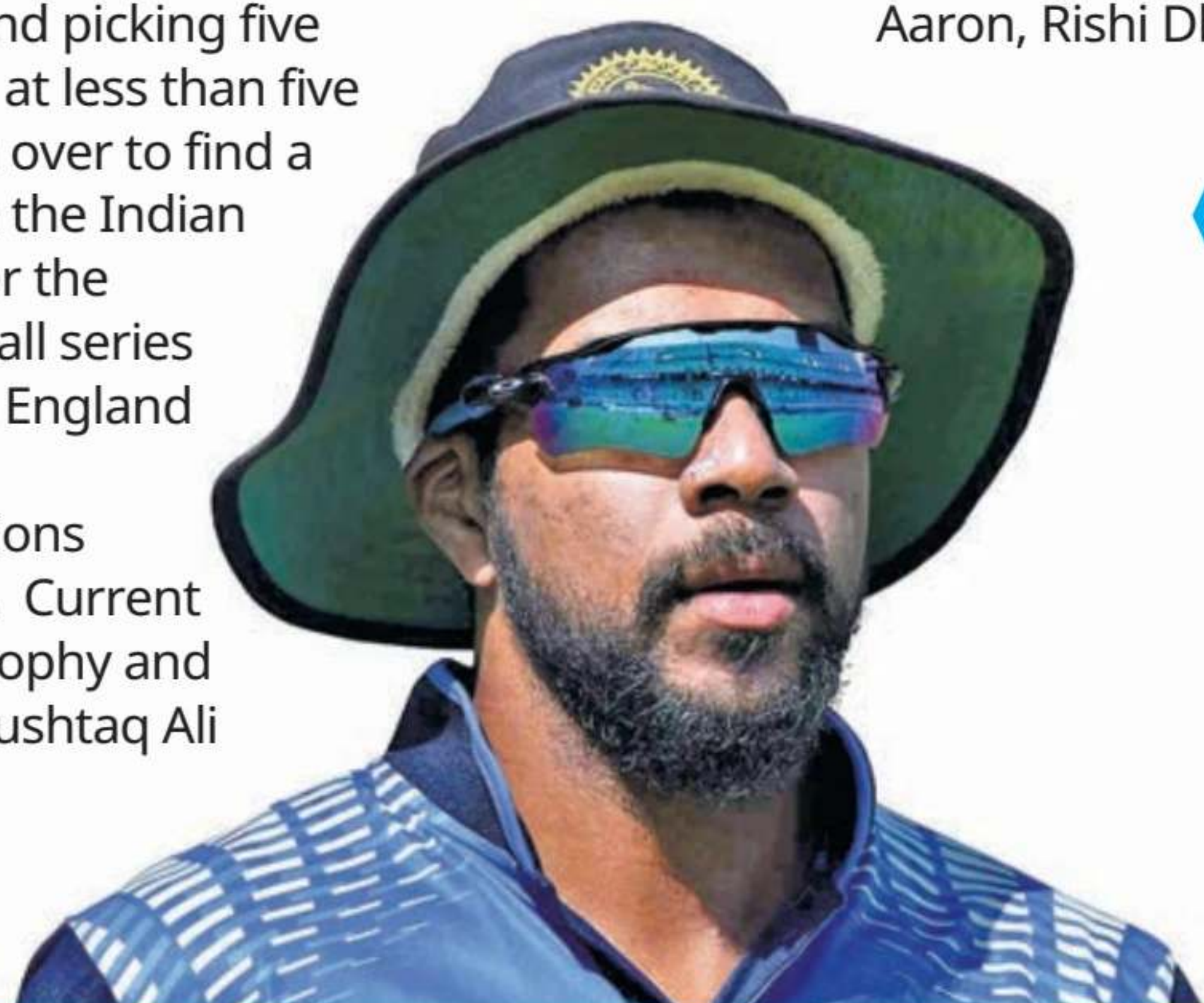
Trophy champion Mumbai's aspirations to complete a treble suffered a setback as the Shreyas Iyer-led side crashed out in the league stage.

However, the skipper enjoyed a good run, scoring 325 runs in five innings, while 17-year-old prodigy Ayush Mhatre turned heads, emerging as the team's top run-getter (458 runs).

Even as the tournament unearthed promising young talent, it also marked the end of Varun Aaron, Rishi Dhawan and

Purple patch: Karun Nair was on a dream run, finishing the Vijay Hazare Trophy with five hundreds and 772 runs. THE HINDU

Sheldon Jackson's storied careers. While Aaron called time on his playing career altogether, the latter two retired from domestic white-ball cricket and will head down the home stretch of their careers with the Ranji Trophy, which resumed after the frenzy of limited-overs cricket.



« Varun Aaron, the former India fast bowler, has announced his retirement from all forms of cricket »